

Participatory Democracy Teaching Notes

A guide to the 42-slide presentation on citizen influence, public voice, and practical democratic institutions.

The central lesson is that participation should make authority answerable to the people affected by it. Broader involvement, careful discussion, and real decision power are connected aims, each with its own difficulties.

Teaching sequence

Allow about 90 minutes including discussion and the design exercise. Slides 40–42 provide references after the conclusion. The suggested times are adjustable planning estimates.

Slides	Focus	Suggested time
1–8	Self-rule and the Riverside case	12 minutes
9–14	Pateman and Barber	13 minutes
15–22	Habermas, Young, and Fraser	18 minutes
23–27	Fung and Wright and public budgets	12 minutes
28–32	Fishkin and Ackerman	12 minutes
33–35	Agenda, time, and technology	6 minutes
36–37	Design exercise and debrief	12 minutes
38–39	Comparison and exit task	5 minutes

A shorter route. For about 55 minutes, use slides 1–10, 12, 15–19, 21, 23–24, 26, 28–29, 31–39. Give the design exercise four minutes and keep the debrief brief. The Slides menu supports these jumps; the document keeps the original numbering.

Preparation and controls

Read the notes for the added thinkers before teaching. All Riverside details are hypothetical. Porto Alegre and America in One Room are historical examples with separate references.

Care with evidence. A theory's rationale, a classroom application, and an empirical finding have different roles. Participation can support learning without guaranteeing it; deliberation can change opinion without establishing truth; advice and a binding decision confer different powers.

Participatory Democracy

Teaching purpose. Introduce the central claim and the lesson's practical question.

Context. This lecture develops a demanding ideal of self-rule, then tests how institutions might make it usable. Participation can mean speaking, proposing, choosing, or reviewing decisions; those powers need to be distinguished.

Teaching approach. Open with a familiar experience: a rule at work, at college, or in a neighborhood that affected students but gave them little influence. Invite two brief examples, then connect them to the claim on the slide.

Distinction to preserve. The modern thinkers differ in their aims. Pateman and Barber defend broad participation; Habermas and Fishkin develop deliberative approaches; Young and Fraser expose barriers to equal voice; Fung and Wright connect participation to government authority.

Next connection. Explain the appeal of self-rule before considering any particular reform.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt

A say in the rules can support freedom

Teaching purpose. State the strongest rationale for participation.

Context. The argument connects freedom with influence over the terms of shared life. An election gives citizens one kind of influence; ongoing participation promises additional opportunities to question and revise decisions.

Teaching approach. Contrast two identical college policies: students had no input into one; they helped draft and review the other. Ask why the procedure could matter even when the final policy is the same.

Discussion prompt. What changes when those affected can help revise a rule?

A useful response. They can expose overlooked burdens and make decision makers explain themselves. A fair procedure can matter separately from whether someone likes the outcome.

Distinction to preserve. This is an argument for democratic authority, not proof that every participant personally consents to every rule.

Next connection. Define participation and deliberation separately.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt

Participation and deliberation

Teaching purpose. Make the relationship between the two traditions precise.

Context. An open vote may involve many people with little discussion. A carefully moderated forum may involve only a small sample. A participatory budget can combine both, depending on its design.

Teaching approach. Give the class two examples: a poll sent to every resident and a weekend discussion among fifty selected residents. Ask which expands involvement and which creates space for considered judgment.

Distinction to preserve. The categories overlap without being synonyms. Representation can also coexist with both. A citizen forum is not automatically a direct democracy or a legislature.

Next connection. A meaningful opportunity to participate must include disagreement.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt
- Pateman 2012
- Stanford method

Dissent belongs inside self-rule

Teaching purpose. Explain why disagreement can improve democratic judgment.

Context. Respect for dissent changes what self-rule demands: citizens need continuing opportunities to contest decisions, not a duty to adopt the majority's opinion.

Teaching approach. Use a library closing time that works for most students but excludes commuters. The majority's preference leaves an identifiable burden that later discussion can uncover.

Discussion prompt. Could a vote be fair while its result still needs revision?

A useful response. Yes. A decision can follow a fair process yet rely on incomplete information or distribute burdens badly.

Distinction to preserve. Preserving dissent does not by itself settle every question about obeying law or civil disobedience.

Next connection. Participation can concern concrete administrative choices as well as laws.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt

Public participation can reach administration

Teaching purpose. Extend democratic influence beyond general legislation.

Context. The distinction between general rules and particular acts matters because people experience many consequences through implementation. Public input need not stop when a legislature passes a law.

Teaching approach. A council approves public transit. Administrators still choose routes and operating hours. Ask which stage matters most to someone returning home after a late shift.

Distinction to preserve. The point supports participation in important administrative decisions. It does not require a public vote on every operational detail.

Next connection. Consider authority outside government as well.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt

Democracy can reach everyday institutions

Teaching purpose. Explain the proposal that democracy should reach throughout social life.

Context. Equal voting rights can coexist with unequal authority in daily relationships. The participatory ideal asks whether people can influence decisions wherever they regularly live under someone else's power.

Teaching approach. Invite students to distinguish influence over a household's shared responsibilities from voting over a person's private choices. The first concerns shared authority; the second can violate autonomy.

Distinction to preserve. Extending democratic principles does not make every personal decision a matter for majority rule. Protecting individual freedom remains necessary.

Next connection. Bring out the ideal's strong claim about obligation, then its limit.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt
- Pateman and Smith 2019

Participation and political obligation

Teaching purpose. Separate a rationale for authority from proof of individual consent.

Context. The demanding version links a participatory society with an obligation to obey. Its appeal is that people become more than passive recipients of rules. The second statement tests the move from influence to consent.

Teaching approach. Suppose a student helps design a college policy but votes against its final version. Their contribution may support the procedure's legitimacy while leaving their disagreement intact.

Discussion prompt. What else would a fair duty to comply require?

A useful response. Possible answers include equal standing, rights, a fair process, or reciprocal obligations. Students should name the additional premise instead of treating participation as automatic consent.

Distinction to preserve. Present the strong thesis as a contested view. The lecture does not establish a general obligation to obey every democratic decision.

Next connection. Introduce a concrete case that will recur through the modern thinkers.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt

Riverside must choose a project

Teaching purpose. Give the facts and the decision before applying theories.

Context. All Riverside facts are invented for classroom analysis. Keep the cost equal so that arguments concern needs and democratic procedure rather than arithmetic. Later slides add clearly stated details.

Teaching approach. Ask for an initial show of hands after stating the facts. Record reasons without declaring a winner. Explain that the class will revisit both the choice and the process used to make it.

Distinction to preserve. Do not present Riverside as a real city, research finding, or account of any thinker's own example. Some students may correctly ask to revise the two-option agenda; preserve that observation for later.

Next connection. Pateman asks what people can learn when they exercise real influence.

Original classroom example or teaching synthesis.

People learn by taking part

Teaching purpose. Explain Pateman's account of learning through participation.

Context. Participation and Democratic Theory (1970) challenged theories that treated ordinary citizens' limited engagement as a reason to keep their role small. Pateman's later account restates the relationship between capacities and democratic authority.

Teaching approach. Use the first attempt to run a student society meeting: participants may learn how to propose an agenda, listen, and revise a plan through practice. Compare that with receiving rules someone else has already set.

Distinction to preserve. This is a developmental argument, not a claim that every meeting improves everyone. Good opportunities and genuine influence matter.

Next connection. Identify what distinguishes an opportunity to speak from a share in authority.

References for this slide

- Pateman 1970
- Pateman 2012

Consultation can leave power untouched

Teaching purpose. Distinguish being heard from having an institutional share in decisions.

Context. Pateman's participatory society involves changing undemocratic authority structures. A participatory label is insufficient if existing decision makers retain all the power.

Teaching approach. Ask students to identify the rule that would have to change in the workplace example. Encourage specific answers: agreed decision rights, an appeal, or a binding procedure.

Discussion prompt. What evidence would show that the workers' influence is real?

A useful response. Look for a defined power to shape rules or outcomes, rather than a promise that a manager will listen.

Distinction to preserve. Advice can still be useful. The comparison identifies a difference in authority, not a claim that every consultation has no value.

Next connection. Test the limits of the learning argument.

References for this slide

- Pateman 2012

Participation needs conditions that support learning

Teaching purpose. Apply a plausible objection to the developmental argument.

Context. This is a classroom inference from the learning argument. A busy institution can invite attendance while offering participants little responsibility. The resulting experience could discourage participation.

Teaching approach. Return to Riverside. Ask whether repeatedly attending a meeting without ever affecting its outcome would build confidence. Have students propose one change that would let newcomers contribute.

Distinction to preserve. Low participation can have several causes. Do not infer that exclusion explains every case, or that participation reliably produces greater political competence without evidence.

Next connection. Barber gives a further reason to participate: public choices can change how people understand their interests.

References for this slide

- Pateman 2012
- Pateman and Smith 2019

Strong democracy develops shared judgment

Teaching purpose. Define strong democracy and explain its distinctive claim.

Context. Strong Democracy (1984) makes participation part of citizenship. Barber allows citizens to govern at some levels and at some times; the ideal does not demand constant involvement in every decision.

Teaching approach. Contrast a list of fixed preferences with a conversation in which people discover a shared problem. Keep the distinction focused on whether preferences can change through public work.

Distinction to preserve. Barber is not simply asking for more frequent opinion polls. His claim concerns the formation of public purposes through ongoing participation.

Next connection. Apply the claim to the budget case.

References for this slide

- Barber 1984

SLIDE 13

Discussion can change Riverside's priorities

Teaching purpose. Illustrate how participation could reshape a public purpose.

Context. This is an interpretation of Barber applied to an invented case. It proposes one possible change in reasoning, not a predicted empirical result.

Teaching approach. Ask the class to describe a reason for changing a preference that differs from simply losing a vote. A park supporter might still enjoy the park while giving priority to another group's more urgent need.

Discussion prompt. What would make a changed view thoughtful rather than pressured?

A useful response. The person should be able to explain the evidence or reason that changed their assessment and remain free to disagree.

Distinction to preserve. Neither agreement nor choosing bus stops is required by Barber's theory in this example.

Next connection. A shared purpose can also conceal pressure to conform.

References for this slide

- Barber 1984

SLIDE 14

A shared purpose can silence a minority

Teaching purpose. State a risk of appeals to community and the consequence for dissent.

Context. Barber distinguishes strong democracy from a coercive unity that erases differences. The objection here tests how a real institution preserves that distinction.

Teaching approach. Imagine a chair saying that continued opposition shows disloyalty to Riverside. Ask students what the chair has substituted for an answer to the objection.

Distinction to preserve. This is a pressure problem, not proof that common purposes are impossible. Appeals to community can support cooperation while still requiring criticism.

Next connection. Habermas places justification at the center of democratic judgment.

References for this slide

- Barber 1984
- Course excerpt

Public decisions need reasons others can question

Teaching purpose. Explain the deliberative ideal of public justification.

Context. Three Normative Models of Democracy (1994) and Between Facts and Norms (English edition, 1996) connect public discussion with constitutional procedures. They concern the conditions under which political authority can be justified.

Teaching approach. Give two explanations for the same spending choice: a donor demanded it; residents offered reasons about its effects. Ask what the second explanation permits other citizens to do.

Distinction to preserve. A persuasive speaker can still be wrong. The ideal concerns an open process of justification, not a guarantee that the most polished argument wins or that everyone reaches agreement.

Next connection. Show what public justification asks of the council in Riverside.

References for this slide

- Habermas 1994
- Habermas 1996
- Course excerpt

Riverside must explain its choice

Teaching purpose. Apply public justification to a concrete decision.

Context. This is an instructional application, not Habermas's own case. Ask whether the council can defend the procedure and the reasons it used, even to residents whose favored project loses.

Teaching approach. Let students improve a weak justification such as "more people liked the park." They may ask who would use each project, whose needs are urgent, and what alternatives staff excluded.

Discussion prompt. What question would you ask before accepting the council's reasons?

A useful response. Good answers identify missing information or an overlooked burden, rather than only restating a preference.

Distinction to preserve. Public reasons can be disputed after the vote. A defensible procedure does not require every person to endorse the result.

Next connection. Deliberation can work through institutions with different responsibilities.

References for this slide

- Habermas 1994

Discussion and government can have different roles

Teaching purpose. Explain how deliberation can coexist with representative government.

Context. Habermas links informal public discussion with organized decision procedures. His account does not require the whole citizenry to act as one body making every decision.

Teaching approach. Use three ordinary roles without turning them into a hierarchy of worth: residents raise a neglected issue; elected officials authorize a policy; staff deliver it. Ask where accountability must connect those roles.

Distinction to preserve. Avoid presenting Habermas as an advocate of replacing legislatures with one continuous town meeting. His framework also takes rights and constitutional procedures seriously.

Next connection. Young asks whether an apparently open discussion actually hears everyone.

References for this slide

- Habermas 1994
- Habermas 1996

Equal invitations can still produce unequal voice

Teaching purpose. Define exclusion within an apparently inclusive forum.

Context. Inclusion and Democracy (2000), especially chapter 2, expands political communication to include acknowledgment, narrative, and rhetoric alongside argument. The concern is unequal credibility as well as formal access.

Teaching approach. Compare a confident expert and a nervous resident describing the same problem. Ask students to distinguish relevance from polish before anyone assesses the speaker's credibility.

Distinction to preserve. Young does not abandon argument or claim that every statement deserves equal evidential weight. Her account asks what communication helps people understand one another.

Next connection. Give a concrete example of relevant experience expressed through a story.

References for this slide

- Young 2000
- Course excerpt

A story can reveal what the figures miss

Teaching purpose. Show how narrative can contribute to judgment.

Context. The cleaner and the unlit stop are additional hypothetical details. The point is that experience can identify a relevant question that an official summary did not raise.

Teaching approach. Ask students to turn the story into a question the council should investigate. Examples: how many people use the stop after dark, what hazards they encounter, and whether the proposed project addresses them.

Discussion prompt. Does hearing this story settle the budget choice?

A useful response. No. It identifies a concern and directs inquiry. Other experiences and evidence still matter.

Distinction to preserve. Neither dismiss the account as merely emotional nor treat one person's account as proof of how everyone experiences transit.

Next connection. Participation can also happen outside a formal meeting.

References for this slide

- Young 2000

Protest can bring an excluded issue into debate

Teaching purpose. Explain the democratic role of communication beyond formal debate.

Context. Young's account includes protest within a broader picture of political communication. Her 2001 essay also frames tensions between activism and deliberative norms; it is an extension for further study.

Teaching approach. Imagine bus users gathering outside the meeting with pictures of unsafe stops. Ask what their action can achieve before a vote occurs.

Distinction to preserve. Protest is not automatically truthful or inclusive. Evaluate what it reveals, how it affects other people, and whether its claims can be tested. The lecture does not establish that every disruptive act is justified.

Next connection. Fraser considers why marginalized people sometimes need spaces of their own.

References for this slide

- Young 2000
- Young 2001
- Course excerpt

Separate forums can widen public debate

Teaching purpose. Explain why one common forum may be insufficient.

Context. Fraser calls these alternative arenas “subaltern counterpublics.” Translate the term immediately as spaces where marginalized groups develop and circulate their own accounts of their needs. Formal openness does not erase unequal power. Her essay critiques the earlier model of the public sphere associated with Habermas; it predates his later constitutional theory.

Teaching approach. An invented night-shift workers’ group compares experiences before meeting officials. Ask what members could learn there that might be hard to say in a forum dominated by employers.

Distinction to preserve. A separate forum is a possible response to exclusion, not a guarantee of justice or an ideal of permanent isolation.

Next connection. Use the idea to revisit who chose Riverside’s options.

References for this slide

- Fraser 1990

Public voice includes challenging the agenda

Teaching purpose. Show how participation can change the question itself.

Context. The workers’ group and missing service are hypothetical. Their discussion exposes how an apparently inclusive vote can exclude a relevant option before anyone casts a ballot.

Teaching approach. Ask students to explain why the initial cost constraint cannot simply settle the new proposal. The council needs to explain whether late service is feasible and whether the spending agenda can change.

Distinction to preserve. Fraser’s separate forums should be able to communicate with the wider public. They can contain their own inequalities; a group’s account also needs scrutiny.

Next connection. Fung and Wright ask how discussion can carry public authority.

References for this slide

- Fraser 1990
- Course excerpt

Participation can carry public authority

Teaching purpose. Define the institutional proposal and its distinctive feature.

Context. Deepening Democracy (2003) studies experiments rather than proposing one universal assembly. The central concern is connecting practical discussion with decision power. Translate “empowered” as having a defined authority to affect what government does.

Teaching approach. Ask students what would change if Riverside’s residents could choose a funded project under published rules rather than offer advice at an optional hearing.

Distinction to preserve. Do not equate every participatory meeting with this model. Actual authority and links to wider public institutions are essential.

Next connection. Implementation still needs people with assigned responsibilities.

References for this slide

- Fung and Wright 2003

Citizen decisions still need implementation

Teaching purpose. Explain why participation and delegation can coexist.

Context. The difficulty is the relation between choosing and acting. A collective decision does not pave a road, prepare a contract, or maintain a service by itself.

Teaching approach. For safer bus stops, ask who checks land access, lighting specifications, and maintenance costs. Then ask who reviews a delay or unexplained change.

Distinction to preserve. Technical skill matters, but expertise does not automatically settle priorities. Staff should explain feasibility constraints in language participants can examine.

Next connection. Local decisions also need connections to institutions beyond the neighborhood.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt
- Fung and Wright 2003

Local control needs wider public oversight

Teaching purpose. Explain a limit of local participation and the institutional response.

Context. The design includes local authority alongside links for resources, responsibility, and review. Participation can reproduce power inequalities if better organized groups dominate.

Teaching approach. Suppose one neighborhood's preferred traffic change sends heavy vehicles into another neighborhood. Ask why local agreement is insufficient.

Distinction to preserve. Oversight can protect outsiders but can also weaken local influence. Have students explain who reviews decisions and what reasons justify intervention.

Next connection. Examine a historical budgeting practice with both local participation and government institutions.

References for this slide

- Fung and Wright 2003

Participatory budgeting in Porto Alegre

Teaching purpose. Introduce a real institutional example without overstating its scope.

Context. Participatory budgeting began there in 1989. Citizens discussed investment priorities within a municipal process; they did not collectively run every operation or decide the entire municipal budget.

Teaching approach. Compare the historical mechanism with Riverside's optional meeting. Ask which decisions each process actually empowers participants to shape.

Distinction to preserve. This is a historical illustration. It makes no claim about Porto Alegre's current process or that participation alone caused all reported social improvements.

Next connection. The budget's size and the rules around it determine the reach of participation.

References for this slide

- World Bank 2006
- Fung and Wright 2003

A small budget gives citizens limited control

Teaching purpose. Explain why a participatory label does not establish broad influence.

Context. Fung's 2006 account examines who participates, how they communicate, and the authority connected to the process. This slide applies the authority dimension to a hypothetical small fund.

Teaching approach. Suppose Riverside invites residents to choose benches but excludes the bus timetable. Ask whether this process addresses the problem raised by night workers.

Distinction to preserve. A narrow process may still be useful. Assess it in relation to its stated purpose and the needs it can actually affect.

Next connection. Fishkin tackles another difficulty: giving careful discussion time to a manageable group.

References for this slide

- Fung 2006
- Pateman 2012

A small sample can have time to think

Teaching purpose. Explain the rationale for a deliberative poll.

Context. The method gives participants an opportunity to consider trade-offs rather than answer immediately. Sampling aims to include a range of people, while moderated discussion makes a large population's problem manageable.

Teaching approach. Ask why an open meeting and a selected sample might attract different people. Keep sampling distinct from electing representatives.

Distinction to preserve. A sample's judgments are evidence about considered opinion. They do not automatically create a right to make binding decisions for everyone.

Next connection. Show the actual steps in the method.

References for this slide

- Stanford method

Deliberative polling compares judgments over time

Teaching purpose. Explain how the method produces its evidence.

Context. The before-and-after design measures changes in individual judgments. Confidential questionnaires reduce pressure to endorse a single group answer. Bigger groups do not automatically deliberate better: more speakers can make it harder to follow an argument or give each participant a turn.

Teaching approach. Reveal each step separately. Ask what the final private questionnaire preserves that a public show of hands might obscure.

Distinction to preserve. The organizers' choice of topics and materials still matters. An opinion change does not by itself demonstrate that a decision is correct.

Next connection. Consider a documented experiment and the limits of its evidence.

References for this slide

- Stanford method
- Fishkin and colleagues 2021

America in One Room tested this approach

Teaching purpose. Give a concrete research finding with a clear comparison.

Context. Fishkin, Siu, Diamond, and Bradburn published their analysis in 2021. The event recruited a sample through NORC and also used a comparison group of 844 registered voters who did not receive the same deliberative intervention.

Teaching approach. The unit of the result is a policy proposal, not a person. Ask students to explain "22 of 26" accurately before considering what it suggests.

Distinction to preserve. The design bundled information, discussion, facilitation, and contact with other participants. The result supports this organized process under these conditions; it does not show that all discussion reduces polarization. Movement toward agreement is also not proof of truth. Not every reported movement was statistically significant.

Next connection. A successful sample still leaves the broader public outside the room.

References for this slide

- America in One Room
- Fishkin and colleagues 2021

A thoughtful sample leaves a participation question

Teaching purpose. Separate thoughtful discussion from broad democratic control.

Context. This compares the deliberative poll's purpose with Pateman's demand for wider changes in authority. The proposals solve different problems and can be combined.

Teaching approach. Suppose Riverside commissions an excellent poll but ignores it. Then suppose the council makes the poll binding without further public explanation. Ask what democratic concern appears in each case.

Distinction to preserve. A deliberative poll is often advisory. A citizens' assembly can have a different remit and may issue collective recommendations; the terms should not be used interchangeably.

Next connection. Ackerman and Fishkin also proposed a broader opportunity before elections.

References for this slide

- Pateman 2012
- Stanford method

Deliberation Day gives discussion a public occasion

Teaching purpose. Explain a distinct, broader design for pre-election deliberation.

Context. Deliberation Day (2004) proposes structured local gatherings. Contrast the breadth of this design with the concentrated time given to a sample in deliberative polling.

Teaching approach. Ask what paid time for discussion might change for a person who otherwise cannot attend an evening meeting.

Distinction to preserve. Describe this as a proposal, not an established national holiday. Do not claim it guarantees turnout, informed judgment, or equal access.

Next connection. Both broad and sampled participation face the problem of who chooses the questions.

References for this slide

- Ackerman and Fishkin 2004
- Fishkin's bibliography
- Course excerpt

The person choosing the question has power

Teaching purpose. Explain the agenda problem with an established example.

Context. Inviting citizens to choose the agenda still requires rules for submitting and selecting topics. There is no effortless escape from the need to design a procedure.

Teaching approach. Ask the class to propose a way residents could request a new item. Then ask how it would handle limited meeting time and competing requests.

Distinction to preserve. Citizen proposals, rotating agenda panels, or appeal rules are possible institutional responses. No single mechanism removes every opportunity for manipulation.

Next connection. Open procedures also need practical access.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt
- Fung 2006
- Fraser 1990

Participation takes time people may not have

Teaching purpose. Explain time costs as both a feasibility and equality problem.

Context. The demand to take part in every decision can crowd out valued activities. Equal invitations do not mean equal spare time.

Teaching approach. Return to the 6 p.m. meeting. Ask how a cleaner working that shift or a parent collecting a child could contribute. Students can consider paid time, childcare, accessible venues, and several ways to submit views.

Distinction to preserve. These access measures are teaching proposals, not findings that every program uses them or that they eliminate all unequal participation.

Next connection. Technology changes some costs but does not resolve the other design problems.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt
- Pateman and Smith 2019

An app changes access and leaves power questions

Teaching purpose. Assess digital participation without treating technology as a complete solution.

Context. Communication technology can reduce some practical barriers. Whether a digital forum is democratic depends on its rules and the connection between participation and authority.

Teaching approach. Imagine the council's app asks residents to choose a park color while blocking new topics. Ask which of the lecture's problems it has solved.

Distinction to preserve. This is a hypothetical analysis. Do not infer that online and in-person deliberation have identical effects or that voting security and accessibility can be taken for granted.

Next connection. Use the thinkers to design a stronger version of Riverside's procedure.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt
- Fung 2006

Riverside needs a fair decision process

Teaching purpose. Use the concepts to design an institution rather than only name thinkers.

Context. Give groups four minutes. Each group should specify one rule for agenda proposals, one way to reach people missing from the meeting, and one defined decision power. Ask them to name a trade-off their design leaves unresolved.

Teaching approach. Keep the facts visible. Clarify that proposing additional options requires a feasibility check; the exercise does not give the city an unlimited budget.

Discussion prompt. Which rule in your design most directly changes who has power?

A useful response. Students should point to a specific authority, such as placing an item on the agenda or choosing among feasible funded projects.

Distinction to preserve. There is no single prescribed theory-consistent winner. Evaluate the procedure and its remaining weaknesses.

Next connection. Offer one possible design after hearing students' proposals.

Original classroom example or teaching synthesis.

One possible Riverside design

Teaching purpose. Show how the theories can inform a concrete procedure.

Context. This is the instructor's synthesis of several concerns, not a plan endorsed jointly by the thinkers. In discussion, add paid participation time, childcare, and outreach to people who use the services but may not attend.

Teaching approach. Reveal each stage and identify the problem it addresses. Then ask what happens to people who lack legal residency, cannot use the voting platform, or bear spillover costs.

Distinction to preserve. The design remains limited to a specified fund and electorate. It still needs rights protections, selection rules, and procedures for revising decisions.

Next connection. Compare improvements in public voice with improvements in authority.

References for this slide

- Fung 2006
- Course excerpt

Voice and authority need separate tests

Teaching purpose. Bring the modern additions together without collapsing them.

Context. The grouping is a teaching comparison, not a rigid taxonomy. Barber and Fung and Wright also care about discussion; Young and Fraser also care about power. Fishkin's method connects considered judgment with a separate question about official uptake.

Teaching approach. Ask the class for a process that improves one dimension while leaving the other weak. An inclusive hearing that cannot affect a decision is one possibility.

Distinction to preserve. No thinker owns only one concern. Use the comparison to identify questions, not to place their entire work into exclusive categories.

Next connection. State the practical consequence of balancing these concerns.

References for this slide

- Pateman 2012
- Barber 1984
- Habermas 1994
- Young 2000
- Fraser 1990
- Fung and Wright 2003

Participation should make authority answerable

Teaching purpose. Give the lecture's conclusion in full sentences.

Context. The conclusion is a teaching synthesis. It preserves the ideal of self-rule while recognizing limits of time, scale, expertise, and unequal power.

Teaching approach. Use an exit task: each student names one rule that would improve Riverside's process, the problem it addresses, and a cost or risk it leaves.

Discussion prompt. Which change would you prioritize, and why?

A useful response. Accept different proposals if students connect a concrete rule to a defined democratic concern and acknowledge a remaining difficulty.

Distinction to preserve. More meetings, more voters, and more agreement are each incomplete measures of democratic quality.

Next connection. Point students to the references and the separate teaching notes for further study.

References for this slide

- Course excerpt
- Fung 2006

References · Participation and justification

Teaching purpose. Provide a traceable bibliography for participation and deliberative legitimacy.

Context. Use the linked primary publications and publisher pages for further study. The lecture uses paraphrases; it does not depend on unattributed quotations.

Teaching approach. For a focused follow-up, pair Pateman's 2012 address with Habermas's 1994 account and ask how much each changes the citizen's institutional role.

Distinction to preserve. Publication dates refer to the named editions. The course excerpt's book edition and printed pagination are not identified by the supplied PDF.

References · Inclusion and institutions

Teaching purpose. Provide primary works for inclusion, agenda challenges, and participatory institutions.

Context. Young's chapter on communication and Fraser's essay make a useful pairing: one tests who can be heard within a forum; the other asks whether a single forum is enough.

Teaching approach. For institutional analysis, use Fung's 2006 dimensions to compare two real participation programs without assuming that their names establish their authority.

Distinction to preserve. The Porto Alegre example is historical. The bibliographic links do not support claims about the current state of that municipal program.

References · Democratic experiments

Teaching purpose. Provide the method, empirical publication, and proposal behind the experiments.

Context. The 2021 article distinguishes the event and its control group from broader claims about a deliberative society. Deliberation Day is a separate proposal from deliberative polling.

Teaching approach. Ask students to identify one claim the experiment supports and one larger claim it cannot establish by itself.

Distinction to preserve. Keep descriptive findings, interpretations, and institutional proposals separate.

Full bibliography

Web references checked October 2, 2026. The presentation uses paraphrases. Page references distinguish the supplied PDF from printed journal or book pages.

Course excerpt

"Rousseau and the general will," section "Participatory democracy," supplied PDF, pp. 16–21. PDF page numbers count from the first page of the supplied file.

Pateman 1970

Carole Pateman, *Participation and Democratic Theory* (Cambridge University Press, 1970), especially chapters II–IV. Publisher contents and chapter descriptions.
<https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9780511720444>

Pateman 2012

Carole Pateman, "Participatory Democracy Revisited," *Perspectives on Politics* 10, no. 1 (2012): 7–19, especially pp. 10–11.
<https://doi.org/10.1017/S1537592711004877>

Pateman and Smith 2019

Carole Pateman and Graham Smith, "Reflecting on Fifty Years of Democratic Theory," *Democratic Theory* 6, no. 2 (2019): 111–120. The publisher's current web version lists an online publication date in 2026; the journal issue is from 2019.
<https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/democratic-theory/article/reflecting-on-fifty-years-of-democratic-theory/4825D6C057371660FF4B328A923DC9C4>

Barber 1984

Benjamin R. Barber, *Strong Democracy: Participatory Politics for a New Age* (University of California Press, 1984; twentieth-anniversary edition, 2004), especially chapters 7–10. The linked publisher page describes the 2004 edition.
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